

Player Quickstart: Speaking Dabar

The short version of making reality listen.

This is a player reference. It explains how to use a registered Phrase in play using the Minimum Viable Dabar (MVP) rules — the canonical table-facing authority for ordinary play.

What Is Dabar?

Dabar is not magic. It does not create energy from nothing. It is a **quantum-harmonic interface** with the Lattice — the entangled network of matter, meaning, and memory that underlies reality.

A Dabar practitioner does not ask the world for an effect. They declare a truthful, bounded state that the damaged world may or may not be able to sustain. The Phrase is a **measurement** — a declaration of what should be true.

Every Phrase has three values you need at the table:

Term	What it tells you
DC	How difficult the Phrase is to cast successfully (10, 15, or 20).
Strain Cost	How much Strain the Phrase costs (1, 2, or 3).
Effect	Exactly what the Phrase is established to do.
Failure Echo	What happens when the Phrase fails.

Use the **MVP Phrase Card Index** or your character's registered Phrase card. A Phrase is playable only after the GM has validated it.

The Casting Loop

1. Choose and Frame the Phrase

Choose a prepared Phrase from your character sheet or the MVP Phrase Card Index. State its theological intent in one sentence:

- What are you restoring?
- What boundary are you protecting?
- What truth are you making visible?
- What are you willing to sacrifice?

The intent gives the GM the direction of a consequence. It is not a morality test and does not provide a flat bonus.

2. Pay the Fixed Cost

Mark the Phrase's printed Strain cost:

Phrase Level	Strain Cost
Minor	1
Major	2
Consequential	3

3. Roll Once

Roll d20 + your character's normal relevant casting modifier against the Phrase's printed DC.

Difficulty	DC	Use
Ordered	10	Minor, reliable, or narrowly scoped effect
Strained	15	Major tactical or sustained effect
Reality-Bending	20	Consequential, broad, lasting, or Fray-facing effect

Frayed Location: If you are in a Frayed location, the GM may raise the DC by 2. Do not stack multiple environmental modifiers.

4. Resolve the Result

Result	What Happens
Critical Success (Natural 20 or total $\geq$ DC + 5)	Best valid effect; no consequence; optional beneficial narrative detail.
Standard Success (total $\geq$ DC)	Effect resolves; no consequence.
Failure (total < DC)	Use the Phrase's printed Failure Echo .
Critical Failure (Natural 1)	Use the Failure Echo and gain a minor narrative complication.

The Phrase card determines the failure experience. No separate Backlash table is used.

The Six-Box Strain Track

Each Dabar user tracks current Strain from 0 to 6:

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Filled Boxes	State	Effect
0–2	Clear	No additional effect.
3–4	Pressured	Gain a visible Fray tell or minor narrative complication.
5	Unstable	The next failed or risky Phrase creates a Personal Condition .
6	Overflow	No safe casting; you may choose Force It (see below).

Recovery

Action	Benefit
Short Rest (10 minutes)	Clear 2 Strain.
Long Rest (8 hours)	Clear all Strain.
Personal Conditions	Do not clear automatically. Resolve through a restorative act, divine intervention, downtime, or narrative milestone.

Force It

At **6 Strain**, before rolling, you may declare **Force It**.

- If the Phrase card says Force It is guaranteed, the Phrase succeeds.
- Otherwise, roll normally.
- You create one **Personal Condition** even if the Phrase succeeds.
- If the act materially changes the location, the GM creates one **Local Condition**.
- You cannot use another Phrase until your Strain is reduced.

Force It replaces the old Overflow system. It is an emergency measure, not a recommended casting style.

Conditions

Personal Conditions

A lasting change to you, such as:

- VOICE CARRIES A SECOND HARMONIC
- MEMORY OF THE CASTING IS INCOMPLETE
- HAND PHASES WHEN UNDER STRESS
- THE CASTING LEFT A VISIBLE SCAR

Local Conditions

A lasting change to a place or future situation, such as:

- LATTICE NODE SCARRED
- WATCH-SPIRE AURA THINNED
- LOCAL TRUST BROKEN
- ASHENFOLD PARTIALLY RESTORED

Record named Conditions, not numeric Drift, during ordinary play.

Theological Tags

Each Phrase has a tag that guides consequence direction:

Tag	Consequence Direction
Mercy / Chesed	Restoration, reconciliation, surrender
Peace / Shalom	Stabilization and prevention of escalation
Judgment	Decisive result with collateral or irreversible risk
Grace	Restoration after vulnerability or sacrifice
Mystery	Uncertainty, incomplete knowledge, interpretation
Witness	Truth preserved, but you or your community are exposed

One-Minute Table Reference

CAST A PHRASE (MVP RULES)

1. Choose a Phrase and state your intent.
2. Mark the Strain cost (1/2/3).
3. Roll d20 + modifier against DC (10/15/20).
4. Success: the Phrase takes effect.
5. Failure: use the Failure Echo.
6. Update your Strain Track.

RECOVERY

- Short Rest (10 min): Clear 2 Strain.
- Long Rest (8 hours): Clear all Strain.
- Personal Conditions: require narrative resolution.

REMEMBER

- Use only registered Phrases.
- One Phrase = one roll = one cost.
- Strain is temporary pressure.
- Conditions are persistent consequences.
- Force It at 6 Strain creates a Condition.
- No Backlash table in ordinary play.